



PRODUCTS AND SERVICES · BUSINESS PAYMENT CONSULTANT

Payment Operations Review

Understanding how deposits, balances, and settlement move through your business today — and where a lighter path exists.

Single-Point Ready-Mix Supplier

Ready-mix concrete · Greater New York · Advance-order model

Prepared by

Kobra™ — Business Payment Consultant

Review date: Summer 2026 · Anonymized sample

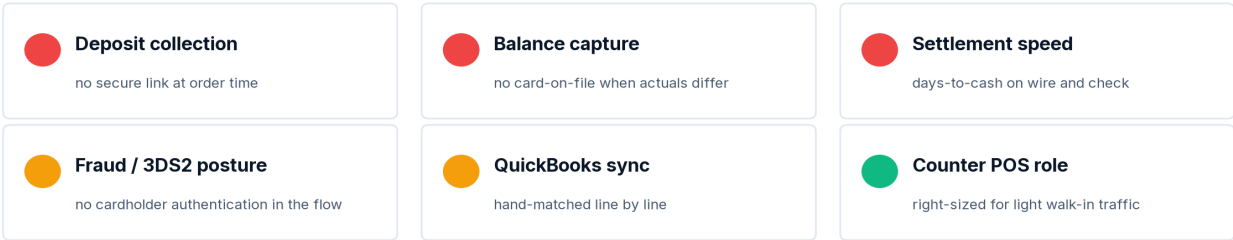
A working draft. Findings reflect what we observed and what you told us during this review. Not a proposal, quote, or binding recommendation.



At a Glance

A ready-mix concrete supplier that takes most orders in advance and settles by wire or cheque. The counter POS handles light walk-in traffic; the operational weight sits on the deposit-and-balance path.

Operational Health



Operational Maturity



A well-established operator with mature dispatch and delivery. The payment collection path — deposits, balance capture, settlement, and reconciliation — has not evolved alongside it.

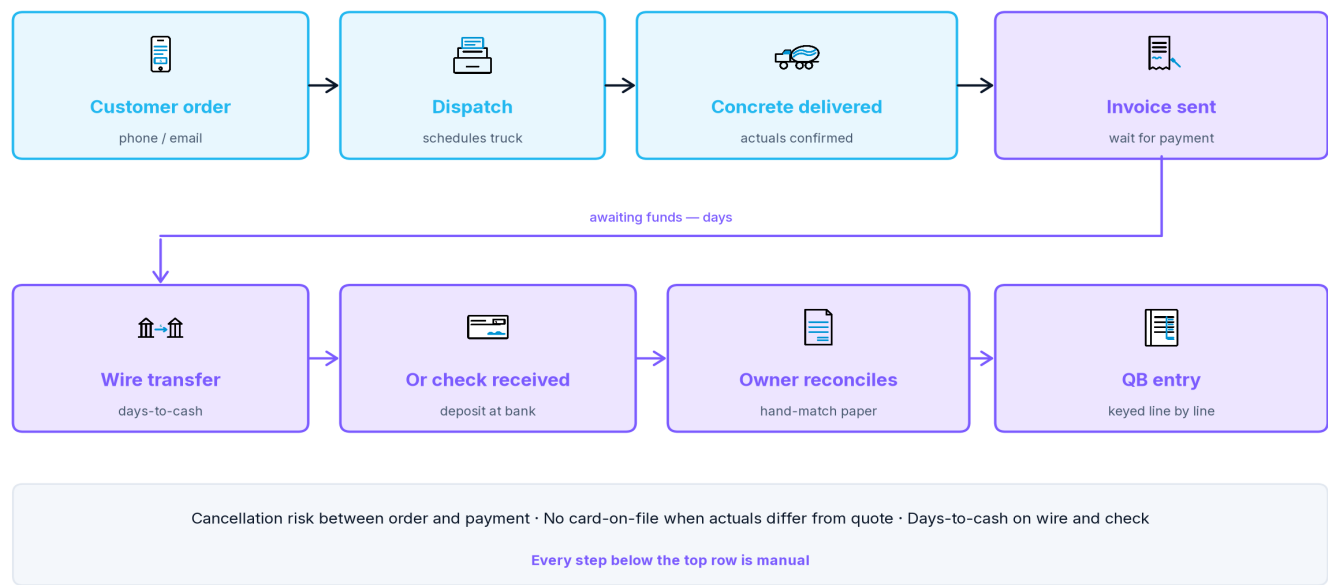
Top Recommendation

Move advance-order collection to a hosted payment link with tokenized card-on-file. A deposit link secures the order the moment it is placed; the card stays on file so the balance can be captured cleanly once actual concrete metres are confirmed. Funds land next business day and lines flow into QuickBooks on their own. Counter POS remains as it is — no disruption to walk-in traffic.



Your Payment Flow Today

Orders come in by phone or email, concrete goes out, and payment follows days later by wire or cheque. The owner ties every deposit slip back to an invoice and re-keys the totals into QuickBooks.



Reading the diagram. The top row is the order-to-delivery path — mostly cyan (systems and channels) until the invoice goes out, which turns purple because it kicks off a manual waiting-and-chasing loop. The bottom row is settlement and reconciliation: wire or cheque comes in on its own schedule, gets deposited at the bank, then the owner hand-matches deposit slips against invoices and re-enters the totals in QuickBooks. Every box below the top row is purple because a person moves the record forward at that step. Between the two rows sits the gap that carries the most operational cost — days of waiting during which the order is not yet secured.



What We Found

Four observations from the review. The deposit-and-balance path is the connective tissue — the other observations follow from the same root cause: card payments are not part of the advance-order flow.



No Secure Deposit at Order Time

WHAT WE SAW

Advance orders are booked on trust: the customer commits verbally, dispatch schedules the truck, and an invoice is sent expecting payment to arrive by wire or cheque. Nothing is charged or held on a card at the moment the order is placed. Between order and delivery, the business is exposed if the customer cancels, changes scope, or simply stops responding.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Cancellation risk sits entirely with the supplier during the days between order and delivery
- A dispatched truck represents fuel, plant time, and driver hours committed before payment
- Chasing an unresponsive customer after delivery is far harder than collecting a deposit up front
- A 15–50% deposit taken at order time meaningfully reduces the operational exposure

A SIMPLER OPERATIONAL MODEL

A hosted payment link sent to the customer at the moment the order is booked — they pay from their phone in under two minutes, no card numbers exchanged over the phone. The deposit posts on the same rails as any card sale and settles next business day.

APPLIES TO YOUR BUSINESS **CLEARLY**

advance-order + wire/cheque workflow confirmed.



No Card-on-File for the Balance

WHAT WE SAW

Concrete jobs almost never bill for exactly the quoted amount — metres delivered, wait time, and pump draws all shift the final number. Today, capturing the balance means issuing a second invoice and waiting again for another wire or cheque. There is no way to charge the customer's card automatically once the actuals are confirmed.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Every job produces a second collection cycle for the difference between quote and actuals
- Customers routinely leave balances outstanding for weeks after the concrete is already poured
- Cardholder authentication (3DS2) at the moment of deposit puts a token on file safely
- The token can be charged the exact confirmed amount — no second invoice, no second wait

A SIMPLER OPERATIONAL MODEL

When the customer authenticates the deposit through the hosted link, the card is tokenized and kept on file against the job. Once dispatch confirms actual metres, the balance is charged from the token automatically. The customer sees a clean receipt for the full amount, and the business is not chasing a second payment.

APPLIES TO YOUR BUSINESS **CLEARLY**

concrete volumes routinely differ from quote.



What We Found — continued

Two more observations — the pace of settlement and the mix of payment methods customers can use today.



Wire and Cheque Settlement Delays

WHAT WE SAW

Wire transfers arrive on the sender's schedule, not the supplier's. Cheques require a physical deposit at the bank and a hold period before the funds are usable. Either way, the money for a job delivered on Monday may not be workable until the following week. Once the funds do land, the owner then hand-matches the deposit slip against the invoice and re-keys the total into QuickBooks line by line.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Days-to-cash on wire and cheque tightens working capital for every job cycle
- Physical bank trips add owner time that could go to sales or dispatch
- Hand-matching deposits to invoices is a nightly reconciliation task, not a one-click sync
- When a wire or cheque is short or wrong, the entire cycle repeats

A SIMPLER OPERATIONAL MODEL

Card payments through a gateway settle to the business account the next business day, with a clean transaction record for every deposit and every balance capture. When the gateway is wired to QuickBooks, the accounting lines match on their own — the owner reviews exceptions instead of re-keying totals.

APPLIES TO YOUR BUSINESS **CLEARLY**



wire + cheque timing confirmed — QB used off-line.



Payment Options Limited to Wire and Cheque

WHAT WE SAW

Some customers prefer to pay by card — for cashflow reasons, to earn card rewards on large jobs, or simply because their AP process runs through a corporate card. Today, that is not really an option. The choice is wire (with the customer's bank on their timeline) or cheque (which someone has to write, mail, and deliver). A card path is not offered at the order stage or at the balance stage.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Business and corporate cards are a common AP tool for buyers in the trades
- Customers who would happily pay by card are pushed onto slower rails they don't prefer
- Losing a large job to a competitor because "we couldn't take a card" is avoidable
- A card path does not have to replace wire and cheque — it sits alongside as a third option

A SIMPLER OPERATIONAL MODEL

A hosted link accepts any card the customer wants to use — debit, personal credit, business credit, or a corporate purchasing card — without any additional integration work. Customers who prefer wire or cheque still have that option; the card path simply removes friction for the buyers who wanted one all along.

APPLIES TO YOUR BUSINESS **LIKELY**

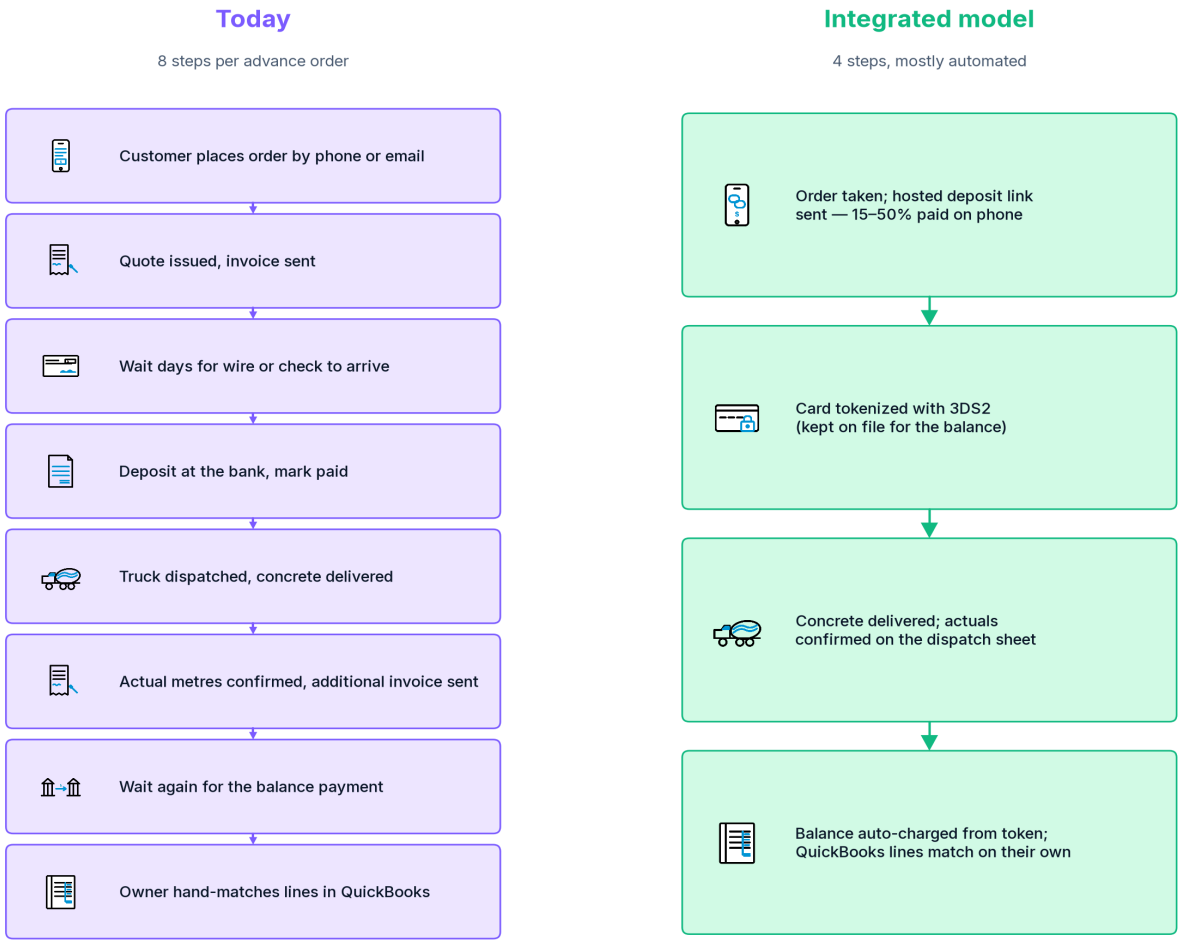


card-preferring customers mentioned during the review.



The Payment Journey

One advance order for concrete, walked step by step — today, and how the same order behaves under an integrated model.

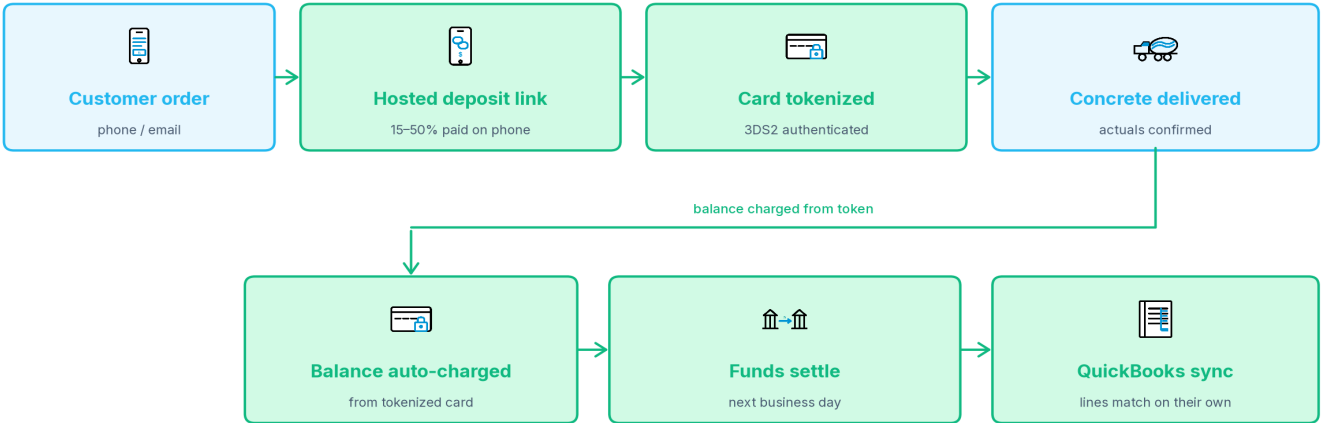


Eight steps collapse to four. What disappears is the wait for wire or cheque, the second invoice for the balance, the physical bank deposit, and the line-by-line QuickBooks entry. What replaces them is one link the customer taps once at order time.



Suggested Payment Flow

One hosted link at order time, one tokenized card-on-file, one automatic balance capture once actuals are known.



Deposit secures the order · Balance capture is automatic when actuals differ · Funds land next business day · QuickBooks stays in step

Counter POS retained for walk-in traffic — no change there

15–50%

deposit secured at order time

Next day

funds settle to the business

Auto

QuickBooks lines reconcile



Areas Worth Discussing

Operational topics that came up during the review and are worth a follow-up conversation.



Order Intake

How advance orders are captured and secured

Deposit Policy

Whether every order carries a deposit — and how the % is set by job size or customer history.

Cancellation Terms

What the current contract says when a customer cancels after dispatch but before delivery.

Order Confirmation

How the customer confirms they're ready — verbal, email, or a signed acknowledgment.



Settlement & Cash

How money moves from customer to bank

Days-to-Cash

The average gap between concrete delivered and funds usable in the business account.

Cheque Handling

Who physically deposits, how often, and what happens when a cheque bounces or is short.

QuickBooks Sync

Whether deposit slips are keyed line by line or matched against invoices in bulk.



Customer & Risk

Buyer preferences and protective controls

Card-Preferring Buyers

How often customers ask to pay by card today — and how those requests are handled.

3DS2 Authentication

Whether cardholder authentication is used at deposit to reduce chargeback exposure.

Business-Card Volume

Whether corporate and business cards from contractors would be a meaningful share of the mix.

Questions We Didn't Have Info For

- ◇ Annual card-eligible volume across advance orders and balance captures
- ◇ Average deposit % the business would want to standardize on (15%, 25%, 50%?)
- ◇ Current QuickBooks version and whether it's Online or Desktop
- ◇ Whether any customers are currently paying by e-transfer, and how that reconciles today
- ◇ Typical spread between quoted metres and delivered metres on a live job
- ◇ Whether pump draws, wait time, and other add-ons should ride on the same balance capture



Kobra's Notes

Solid ready-mix operator — dispatch is tight, the counter POS is quiet and appropriately sized, and the team knows its customers. The gap is entirely on the money-in side: advance orders are booked on trust, balances need a second collection cycle, and the owner spends time each week matching cheques and wires to invoices. A hosted deposit link with tokenized card-on-file removes the three biggest operational costs — cancellation exposure, second-invoice balance chasing, and manual reconciliation — without touching anything about the counter or the dispatch board. Sequence: pilot the link on the next few advance orders, prove the deposit and next-day funding cycle, then set a standing deposit % as the default across all new jobs.



Business Payment Consultant Notes

A note from Kobra on how to read this review.

Kobra prepared this review using the information available during your assessment. The goal is not to recommend changing providers or purchasing specific products. The purpose is to help visualize how payments currently move through your business and identify operational areas that may deserve further review.

If you'd like, a NapaPay Business Payment Consultant can review these findings with you and discuss practical ways to simplify payment operations.

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